

Interview Notes - Father working casual jobs in construction

1. Can you describe your current experience with purchasing nutrient-dense foods?

As someone who works casual construction jobs, income is never stable. Nutrient-dense foods like chicken or liver are luxuries. We mostly eat ugali and sukuma. On good days, we buy small dried fish, but not often.

2. How do you typically decide where to buy your food?

I go to the cheapest source available. Small vendors around my area know me and sometimes allow partial payments. Supermarkets are too expensive, and digital delivery seems far from my reality.

3. Have you ever used a digital platform to purchase food?

No, I have not. Data costs, lack of trust, and the need to see food before buying prevent me from using them.

4. If a digital delivery service offered nutrient-dense foods at a lower price, how would that impact your decision?

If it was cheaper and reliable, I would try. But trust is the main issue—freshness, weight, and timely delivery are my concerns.

5. What are your thoughts on affordability of nutrient-dense foods?

They are too expensive. Eggs at 20 shillings each are hard to buy regularly. A fair price would be 12–15 shillings.

6. Can you describe your current experience with purchasing small dried fish or liver?

Dried fish is sometimes affordable, but quality varies. Liver is expensive, so we eat it rarely. Sometimes I only afford sukuma and ugali.

7. How do high food prices impact your family?

We eat less protein and fewer fruits. For example, instead of milk, my children often drink plain tea. Meals are repetitive and lack variety.

8. If a digital platform offered small dried fish and liver at lower prices, how likely would you be to use it?

I would use it if it was cheaper, trustworthy, and accepted cash on delivery. Freshness would be key.

9. What alternatives do you currently use to cope with high food prices?

Sometimes I work extra hours, but when there's no work, I buy food on credit. We also skip meals or reduce portion sizes. These are not sustainable.

10. Would you be willing to pay a small fee for the convenience of ordering online?

Maybe 20 shillings per order. Anything more feels like too much for my income.

11. Can you describe your current experience accessing nutrient-dense foods for your children?

It's very difficult. Protein is rare in our diet. The children eat more maize and vegetables than anything else.

12. How do you ensure your children have a diverse diet?

I try to buy beans when I can, but fuel costs make cooking them expensive. Mostly, we rely on sukuma for variety.

13. What types of foods do you wish were more accessible?

Milk, eggs, fruits, and chicken. These are important for children's growth, but prices are too high.

14. If a digital service offered affordable, nutrient-dense foods, how likely would you be to use it?

I would try it if it truly saved me money and was reliable. Trust in quality is my main concern.

15. What would you be willing to pay for a service improving dietary diversity?

Maybe 150 shillings per month, but only if I could clearly see the benefits in my children's meals.